

Retention Playbook P6 - Recommendation Quality & Early Intervention

When this applies

This playbook has two related triggers. First, a low `completion_ratio` (the subscriber skips a high proportion of tracks rather than finishing them) - this signals recommendation dissatisfaction: the subscriber is opening the app and starting sessions, but what is being served is not landing, which is a different failure mode from simply not using the app. Second, a negative `activity_trend` (listening activity is declining relative to the prior period) - this is an early-warning signal that should be acted on before it shows up as low `active_days_30` or dormancy.

Recommended interventions - `completion_ratio`

A high skip rate is a signal to intervene on the recommendation experience itself, not on the subscriber's usage habits. Prompt the subscriber to explicitly re-rate or refresh their taste profile (a short "tell us what you like" flow) rather than sending more volume of the same kind of recommendation that is already being skipped. Where available, surface a small number of curated, editorially-selected playlists as an alternative to the algorithmic feed for a trial period - this isolates whether the issue is the recommendation model or a genuine mismatch between the subscriber's taste and the catalog.

Recommended interventions - `activity_trend`

A negative `activity_trend` should be treated as the earliest actionable warning in the engagement family - by the time `active_days_30` or `recency_days` themselves look bad, the subscriber is already most of the way to dormant. Because this is a leading indicator rather than a confirmed problem, the appropriate response is lightweight: a single check-in style prompt surfacing something new and relevant, without the heavier escalation used for confirmed dormancy (Playbook P4). Treat a negative trend as a one-touch nudge, not a full win-back campaign - over-escalating on a leading indicator risks annoying subscribers who would have recovered on their own.